

Philipp Hilbert. *AI-literate Proxy Product Owner, translating ambiguity into delivery.*

Positioning, 13 years turning unstructured AI and data ambitions into prioritised, implementation-ready backlogs, across regulated industries and cross-functional teams.

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Dear Marcela Campos,

I am applying for the Proxy Product Owner (AI Domain Consultant) engagement at Reply Deutschland SE. With 13 years of end-to-end product ownership and the last three years spent specifically on AI and data platform programmes in regulated, engineering-heavy environments, I can step in immediately as the business-facing lead who translates AI ambitions into a delivery-ready backlog.

The role description maps closely to work I have already done. At Rohde & Schwarz I was the product manager for an internal AI and data platform supporting the FCAS European defence programme. That meant facilitating cross-functional workshops with multinational teams of architects, data scientists, and engineers, instrumenting competing workflows to surface what users actually used versus what looked good in a demo, and restructuring the delivery approach when the evidence pointed away from the original plan. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform, drove the migration from bare-metal to containerised environments, and introduced Dagster and dbt so data pipelines ran without hand-holding. Both programmes demanded the same discipline the posting describes: structuring ambiguous topics, driving decisions across business and technical teams, and keeping traceability and governance intact as the backlog evolved.

Jira and Confluence are my daily tooling. I maintain backlogs, write epics and user stories with explicit acceptance criteria, and track velocity and release readiness at the programme level. I also bring honest use-case challenge: at CLINET Platforms I cut a roadmap to its top ten percent of features and user acceptance rose fivefold. The habit of asking "what is this use case actually worth, and can we prove it before we build it?" is one I apply consistently, which is exactly what the posting means by challenging use-case value and defining pragmatic delivery slices.

I do not have direct automotive OEM experience, and I want to name that clearly rather than paper over it. What I do bring is a strong pattern match: regulated stakeholder environments with high governance demands, AI and data delivery lifecycles from ideation to MVP to industrialisation, and the ability to earn technical credibility with engineering teams quickly. The domain specifics of warranty, aftersales, or commercial systems I would learn in the first weeks; the structural and facilitation skills transfer directly.

My German is native and my English is C2 business and technical fluency. I am open to relocating to Munich and available at short notice.

I would welcome a call to discuss the programme context and how I can contribute from day one.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
